

Business Requirements Document (BRD)

Project Name: Digital Closet App

Document Version: 0.4

Date:

Document History

Version	Date	Author	Description
0.1		Bao	Initial draft (original template structure)
0.2		Bao	Restructured onto standard BRD template; merged case study, business rules, and epics
0.3		Bao	Added Market & Gap Analysis and Epics
0.4		Bao	Expanded Market & Gap Analysis with additional competitors (Cladwell, Smart Closet, ClosetSpace, ShopLook, GlamOutfit) and updated Acloset user-count figure

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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose of the Document

This Business Requirements Document defines the business objectives, scope, and business-level requirements for the Digital Closet App project – a solo Business Analyst case study.

This document is scoped to Business Analyst responsibilities: understanding and evidencing *why* the requirements exist (business needs, market context, gap analysis, business rules, Epics).

1.2 Scope of the Project

In scope (Must-have): account creation and login, personal information (measurements, personal color), item add/edit/delete with photo, hashtags and notes per item, closet grid/list view, hashtag search.

In scope (Should-have): automatic background removal, Look (outfit canvas), Collection (grouping by hashtag or manual selection), Trip (day-by-day outfit planning).

In scope (Could-have): customizable app theme.

Out of scope: digital mannequin (virtual try-on), AI outfit suggestion, web platform (mobile-only), third-party sign-in/ payment/social-sharing integrations.

1.3 Document Overview

Section 3 covers the current (manual, non-digital) closet process and the problems it causes. Section 4 places this against the existing market to identify a genuine gap rather than assuming one. Section 5 describes the proposed solution at business level: description, business rules, and Epics. Sections 6-10 cover stakeholders, constraints, assumptions, risks, and dependencies. Section 11 addresses sign-off, not applicable in the traditional sense for a solo project.

2. Business Objectives

2.1 Business Goals

- Help users quickly browse everything they currently own in their closet.
- Reduce the time and effort needed to put together an outfit for a specific occasion.
- Help users prepare organized outfits when traveling for work/leisure.

2.2 Project Objectives

- Deliver a mobile-only application covering the full Must-have and Should-have feature scope defined in Section 1.2.

- Produce this app as a complete, documented Business Analyst case study.

Quantified business goals (target users, revenue, if applicable) have not been defined.

2.3 Success Criteria

Candidate metrics, **not yet tied to quantified targets**: - Repeat usage (weekly active use) - Time saved when finding/choosing an outfit - % of the closet combined into Looks

Specific target thresholds (e.g., “70% of users return within the first week”) have not been defined.

3. Current Business Environment

3.1 Current Processes

Users currently manage their wardrobe through one of two informal methods, with no digital tooling support:

1. **Physically going through the closet, trying items on directly.**
2. **No fixed process – spontaneous**, with outfit decisions made in the moment.
[Open closet] -> [Search item by item] -> [Try on] -> [Select/discard]

^ (repeated multiple times)

[Decide on outfit]

3.2 Challenges and Issues

Issue	Description
Time spent searching	Must physically dig through the closet and try items on, since there's no way to view everything at once.
Forgetting owned items	Without a digital record, users forget items they already own, leading to underused pieces.
Difficulty packing for trips	Outfit prep is especially difficult when packing for a trip or event, with no way to plan ahead.
Can't reuse past outfit combinations	Past outfit combinations have to be memorised; otherwise styling effort is repeated every time, or users would have to dig through old photos to recreate one.

Root causes: the closet only exists physically, with no digital record. For users who own a large number of items, there is no efficient way to search or filter by criteria (color, type, occasion), and nowhere to save past outfit combinations for reuse.

These challenges are based on the project owner's own self-identified pain points, not on formal user interviews or surveys. The target audience (women managing their own wardrobes) is assumed to share similar pain points, but this has not been validated with outside users.

3.3 Expected Value of the Proposed Change

Criteria	Current (manual)	Proposed (Digital Closet)
Viewing the closet	Open the physical closet, search item by item	View everything in the app, grid/list mode
Finding a specific item	Search by eye, no supporting tool	Search by hashtag
Risk of forgetting owned items	High, no record exists	Reduced – every item saved with photo/hashtags
Reusing past outfit combinations	Have to remember or dig through old photos	Saved as a Look, reusable anytime

Quantified improvement (e.g., “reduces outfit-selection time by X%”) has not been measured.

4. Market & Gap Analysis

4.1 Existing Alternatives

Digital wardrobe/outfit-planning apps are an established, populated category, not an empty market. Researched as of 2026 (current app-store listings and comparison sites, cross-checked against an older but more detailed hands-on review), the main players fall into three approaches:

- **Catalog-first apps** (photograph and tag every item, then browse/plan from the catalog): **Stylebook** (iOS only, one-time purchase around \$4-6, the most granular manual organization – custom categories, cost-per-wear statistics, packing lists – but a dated interface, a genuinely time-consuming setup reported at several hours, and background-removal quality that often needs manual correction), **Whering** (free, catalog-first, sustainability and cost-per-wear tracking, but weaker outfit-generation features), and **Acloset** (uses AI to auto-tag items during upload to reduce manual entry, plus weather-based outfit suggestions and virtual try-on; reports around 8 million users as of 2026, though auto-tagging accuracy is inconsistent and a paywall tends to appear once a closet passes about 100 items).
- **Database/suggestion-first apps**, which reduce manual photo entry by letting users pick items from a pre-built clothing database instead of photographing their own: **Cladwell** (capsule-wardrobe focused, daily weather-based outfit picks, rated highest for ease of onboarding in an independent hands-on comparison) and **Smart Closet** (large clothing database linked to real retailers, background removal, packing lists, outfit randomization).
- **Outfit planners**, lighter on cataloging and more focused on combining items into outfits: **Pureple** (free, simpler outfit planning) and **ShopLook** (inspiration/collage-focused, minimal closet organization).

- **Social-first platforms**, where the wardrobe builds from social activity rather than manual cataloging: **Outflik** (AI stylist chat, no manual cataloging required) and **GlamOutfit** (post outfits for community feedback, or request outfits from other users).
- **Older/declining entrants: ClosetSpace** launched with retail- partnership backing (storage and shopping tie-ins) but user reviews describe it as no longer being actively updated, with users migrating to alternatives like Smart Closet.

This list combines some current (2026) sources with one detailed but older hands-on review (originally published 2018) for feature-level depth not available in newer, shallower comparison articles – pricing, user counts, and app availability may have changed since each source was written, and none of this reflects first-hand testing by the project owner.

4.2 Gap Analysis

Being candid about where Digital Closet does and doesn't differ from what already exists:

Where it overlaps with existing players (not a novel gap): - Manual photo cataloging with hashtags/notes – the same core mechanic as Stylebook, Whering, and Acloset. - Outfit-combination canvas (“Look”) – comparable to the outfit-building features already in Whering, Acloset, and Smart Closet. - Day-by-day outfit planning (Trip) – comparable to Stylebook and Smart Closet’s packing-list features, and to ClosetSpace/GlamOutfit’s calendar-sync features. - Background removal on item photos – standard across nearly every competitor reviewed (Stylebook, Acloset, Smart Closet); several reviews note this feature is often imperfect even in established apps, so matching (not exceeding) competitor quality would be a reasonable bar.

Where there may be a genuine, if modest, gap: - Most competitors lean on AI-assisted tagging, outfit suggestion, or a pre-built clothing database as their core differentiator (Acloset, Cladwell, Smart Closet, Outflik). Digital Closet’s Must/Should-have scope deliberately excludes AI features and databases (see Section 1.2, Won’t-have), positioning it closer to Stylebook’s fully manual-control approach – but aiming to avoid Stylebook’s specific pain points (iOS-only, paywall, hours-long setup, unreliable background removal). Several competitors (Acloset at ~8M users) show real demand for this app category – but also that a new entrant needs a clear reason to switch, which this case study does not yet establish through validated user research (see Section 3.2 note). - The declining/abandoned entrants (ClosetSpace) suggest execution and ongoing maintenance matter as much as initial feature set in this category – a risk-relevant observation for Section 9.

This gap analysis is based on published third-party reviews and app-store listings, not a structured competitor audit (hands-on feature testing, pricing-tier comparison, app-store rating analysis).

5. Proposed Solution (Business-Level)

5.1 Description of the Solution

Digital Closet is a mobile-only app that lets users digitize their closet (clothes, accessories, makeup) by photographing each item, tagging it, and organizing it into a searchable, browsable digital collection. Users can combine items into outfits (“Looks”), group items/Looks into Collections, and plan outfits ahead of time for a Trip. See Section 3.3 for the expected value of this change, and Section 4 for how it compares to existing market alternatives.

5.2 Business Rules

ID	Rule
BR-RULE-01	An item must belong to exactly one of three groups: Clothes, Accessories, or Makeup.
BR-RULE-02	A Look must contain at least two items to be saved.
BR-RULE-03	Deleting an item removes it from any Look that references it. [whether the Look itself is deleted, or just shows the item as removed, is an open design decision, not yet confirmed.]
BR-RULE-04	Searching by multiple hashtags returns only items matching all hashtags (AND logic).
BR-RULE-05	Users can add one or more Looks or items for each day within a Trip.

5.3 Epics

Epics group the business requirements into the major bodies of work, tying each back to the business objective it serves. Detailed Functional Requirements, Use Cases, and Acceptance Criteria for every item listed below live in the separate **Functional Specification** document.

Epic	Business Objective
Epic 1: Account & Profile	Let users securely own and personalize their closet data
Epic 2: Closet Management	Let users digitize, organize, and quickly retrieve items – directly addresses “time spent searching” and “forgetting owned items”
Epic 3: Outfit Styling (Look)	Let users build and save reusable outfit combinations – addresses “can’t reuse past outfit combinations”
Epic 4: Organization (Collection)	Let users group items/Looks around their own categories

Epic	Business Objective
Epic 5: Trip Planning	Let users plan outfits ahead of a trip or event – addresses “difficulty packing for trips”

Each Epic would normally be broken down and estimated by a PM/PO during backlog planning – that breakdown is out of BA scope and not included here.

6. Stakeholders

6.1 List of (Possible) Stakeholders

Name	Role
Bao	Business Analyst
–	Product Owner
–	Project Manager
–	UI/UX Designer
–	Developer(s)
–	QA/Tester
–	Scrum Master
–	Sponsor/Executive
End users (not individually named)	Women with a need to manage their closet – primary target user group

This is a solo BA case study – only the Business Analyst role is actually filled. The other roles are listed to reflect a realistic project team structure, not because they are staffed.

6.2 Roles and Responsibilities

Business Analyst: requirements gathering, process analysis, market/gap analysis, business rules documentation, Epic definition, stakeholder management.

Responsibilities for the other listed roles are standard industry definitions, not confirmed against this specific project..

7. Constraints

7.1 Budgetary Constraints

Development budget not yet defined.

7.2 Timeline Constraints

MVP timeline not yet defined.

7.3 Regulatory Constraints

Not yet evaluated. The app stores personal data (body measurements, photos), so data-privacy handling is relevant and should be reviewed.

Platform constraint: mobile-only (iOS/Android), specific mobile framework (native iOS/Android, React Native, Flutter...) has not been finalized.

8. Assumptions

8.1 List of Assumptions

- Users have a smartphone and are willing to photograph/upload each item in their own closet.
- Users own a large enough number of items that they cannot easily memorize or browse them all, making a digitized closet genuinely useful rather than overkill.

9. Risks

9.1 List of Risks

Risk	Description	Likelihood/Impact
Limited resources	Solo effort, may affect timeline	Not yet assessed
Scope creep	The Could-have/Won't-have feature list (AI, custom theme, digital mannequin) is easy to pull into the build prematurely	Not yet assessed
Weak market differentiation	Per Section 4.2, most of the Must/Should-have scope overlaps with existing competitors – the case study has not yet established a validated reason for a user to switch	Not yet assessed

9.2 Risk Mitigation Strategies

- **Limited resources:** scope the MVP strictly to the Must-have tier first; treat Should-have and Could-have as later phases.

- **Scope creep:** explicitly labeled Could-have/Won't-have items (Section 1.2) should not be started until all Must-have and Should-have items are complete.
- **Platform direction change:** confirm the mobile framework choice (Section 7.3) before starting any build work, to avoid rework.
- **Weak market differentiation:** treat this as a portfolio/learning exercise rather than a go-to-market plan; if pursued further, conduct real user interviews (Section 3.2) and a structured competitor audit (Section 4.2) before investing in a build.

These are suggested mitigation approaches based on standard BA practice.

10. Dependencies

10.1 List of Dependencies

Dependency	Description
Background-removal service/API	<i>Automatic background removal</i> likely requires a third-party image-processing service or API, which may carry a cost – needs selection before Should-have build work starts.
Mobile framework decision	Assume a single mobile codebase; the framework choice (Section 7.3) affects the implementation approach.
Figma design file	Wireframes/mockups referenced in the case study are maintained in Figma and are a dependency for any implementation work.

11. Approval

11.1 Sign-off

Not applicable (solo BA case study with no external client or sponsor). Draft status and changes are tracked in the Document History table (top of this document).

This is a draft based on information provided by the project owner as of this point in time. Items marked need to be filled in or confirmed before the BRD is considered complete.